

Stop speculators from taking Altadena

A fair recovery — not a fire sale.

As of June 12, 2026 · verify bill status before circulating

What's happening

After the Eaton Fire, outside investors are buying burned lots from survivors — often **elderly, underinsured families** — for far less than they're worth, then using a state law, **SB 1123**, to pack **up to 10 units** onto a single family's lot with **no public hearing**. **Many sellers may not be getting fair value for their land**. A pending bill (SB 1116) would make this harder to stop; another (SB 1090) is meant to protect us — but as written it starts too late and lets too many projects through.

The threat in numbers

45 of 94

recent lot sales bought by corporations
— up from just 5 a year earlier

up to 10

units a speculator can build on one
family's burned lot under SB 1123

no

public hearing required — almost no
say for the community or its neighbors

Altadena has long been a diverse, family-rooted community. Unchecked speculation strips generational wealth and displaces people who've lived here for decades. This isn't about blocking housing — it's about protecting survivors.

It's also a safety problem. Altadena's narrow, often single-access foothill streets just failed in a deadly evacuation. Packing up to 10 units onto each burned lot — with no sidewalks, septic systems instead of public sewer, and undersized roads — overwhelms the evacuation routes and infrastructure these blocks were never built for. It also shows these lots don't fit the urban-infill premise SB 1123 assumes.

The three things we're asking for

1 Demand emergency action — Supervisor Barger must press the Governor for an executive order

The Palisades got an emergency order — but tied to a fire-hazard map that leaves most of Altadena out. We didn't get a protection written for us; we got a hand-me-down that doesn't fit. As our representative and SB 1090's sponsor, Supervisor Barger has the standing to fix it — she must **press the Governor for an order protecting the whole Altadena disaster area now** (covering the SB 1123 lot-split pathway). SB 1090 doesn't take effect until 2027, and survivors can't wait.

2 Pass and strengthen SB 1090

Make the protection apply **from the fire date, January 7, 2025, through January 7, 2030, to every project without an issued building permit** — so speculators can't race to file before it takes effect. SB 1090 is still pending and may only protect going forward, which is why the emergency order can't wait.

3 Carve Altadena out of SB 1116

We're not blocking housing statewide — only **exempting our disaster area** so Altadena can recover before these density laws are expanded.

What you can do — today

Call and email your representatives. Phone calls count most. Use these points:

- I'm an Altadena community member. **Predatory speculators are taking burned lots from fire survivors** for a fraction of their value.
- **Supervisor Barger / Governor:** issue an emergency order pausing SB 1123's by-right lot-splitting across the whole Altadena disaster area now — not just the fire-hazard map that left us out. The Palisades got this kind of order.
- **Senator Pérez / Assemblymember Harabedian:** pass and strengthen SB 1090 to run from Jan 7, 2025 and cover any project without a building permit; and carve Altadena out of SB 1116.
- The emergency order is the only tool that can act **now** and reach the projects already filed — SB 1090 is still pending and may only protect going forward.

Subject: Protect Altadena fire survivors — fix SB 1090 and act now

Dear [Senator Pérez / Assemblymember Harabedian / Supervisor Barger / Governor Newsom],

I'm a member of the Altadena community. Outside investors are buying burned lots from traumatized, often elderly and underinsured fire survivors — many of them longtime, multigenerational residents — for a fraction of their true value, then using SB 1123 to subdivide them into up to 10 units. This is stripping generational wealth from a community that has already lost everything.

I urge you to: (1) **issue or request an emergency executive order now** suspending the SB 1123 by-right lot-split pathway throughout the entire Eaton Fire disaster area (ZIP 91001/91003) — not just the fire-hazard map the Palisades order used; this is the only tool that can reach the projects already filed; (2) **pass and strengthen SB 1090** — still pending, and even if it passes it may only protect going forward — so it runs from **January 7, 2025 through January 7, 2030** and covers any project **without an issued building permit**; and (3) **carve Altadena out of SB 1116**, exempting our disaster area while we recover.

Altadena deserves a fair recovery. Please stand with our survivors.

[Your name · street address · ZIP code]

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